

Spread Layout Checklist

Architecture Portfolio Studio · Class 06 · Kent State University

Check off each item as you build out your whole project tonight. Every item ties to a principle from tonight's lecture.

1 · Before You Start

- ☐ Real project file from Session 05 open, the one with grid, baseline, and paragraph styles already built
- ☐ Every spread, 6-7 total, ready to build out tonight with real content, not placeholder boxes

2 · Declutter, Pair It

- ☐ One main idea named for each spread before placing anything else on it
- ☐ Decorative elements that don't contribute to the argument removed
- ☐ Every caption reinforces its image, it does not just repeat what the image already shows

3 · Keep It Together, Pattern It

- ☐ Each caption placed directly against the image it describes, not floating in a separate block
- ☐ Related elements grouped by proximity and alignment, so unrelated images are not reading as a pair

4 · Lead the Eye

- ☐ Dominant element named on each spread, claiming at least 40% of the spread
- ☐ Supporting images clearly sized smaller than the dominant element, not competing with it

5 · Flow It, Signal the Path

- ☐ Dominant image and project title positioned on the spread's natural scanning path
- ☐ Each spread labeled consistently, a section marker, project title, or page number

6 · Let It Breathe

- ☐ Every margin and gutter checked, empty space is there because it was chosen, not because it wasn't filled yet
- ☐ No content crowding the dominant element's edges

7 · Grid Breaks, Only If Earned

- ☐ A break taken only if a reviewer would read it as intentional, not accidental
- ☐ Grid left fully intact on any spread where nothing earned a break tonight

This checklist applies tonight's eight reader-centered principles directly to your real spreads. For the research behind each one, see this week's optional reading, "How the Eye Reads a Spread."